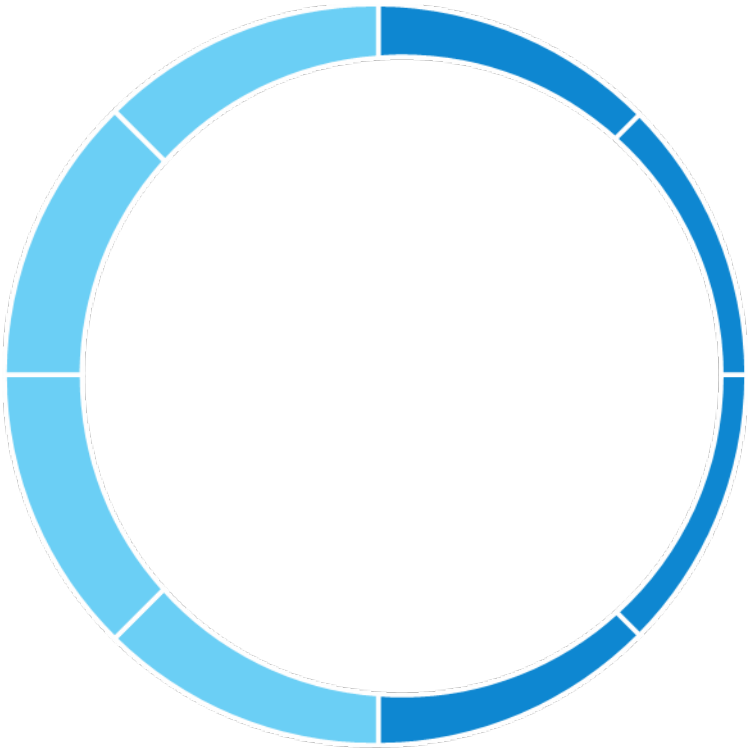


ICTWEB201

Use social media tools for collaboration and engagement

Learner Guide

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Getting Started

About this unit

This unit describes the skills and knowledge required to establish a social networking presence, using social media tools and applications. It includes the requirement to review, compare, and use different types of social networking tools and applications. It applies to information and communications technology (ICT) personnel who need to develop a social networking web presence for a small or large office environment, using social media tools and applications.

Elements and performance criteria

Elements define the essential outcomes of a unit of competency. The Performance Criteria specify the level of performance required to demonstrate achievement of the Element. They are also called Essential Outcomes.

Follow this link to find the essential outcomes needed to demonstrate competency in this Unit https://training.gov.au/Training/Details/ICTWEB201

Icon Legends

	**Learning Activities** Learning activities are the tasks and exercises that assist you in gaining a clear understanding of the content in this workbook. It is important for you to undertake these activities, as they will enhance your learning. Activities can be used to prepare you for assessments. Refer to the assessments before you commence so that you are aware which activities will assist you in completing your assessments.
	**Readings (Required and suggested)** The required reading is referred to throughout this Learner Guide. You will need the required text for readings and activities. The suggested reading is quoted in the Learner Guide, however you do not need a copy of this text to complete the learning. The suggested reading provides supplementary information that may assist you in completing the unit.



Topic 1 –Different types of social media tools

This unit will give you the skills to establish a social networking presence using social media tools and applications. You will look at and compare the different types of social media. You will then set up and use popular social media tools and applications. To complete this unit you need to:

- Read through the topics in all the notes
- Complete the activities in these notes
- Complete and return the Assessment Events

1.1 What is social media?

Social media is the use of a variety of media for the purpose of social networking.

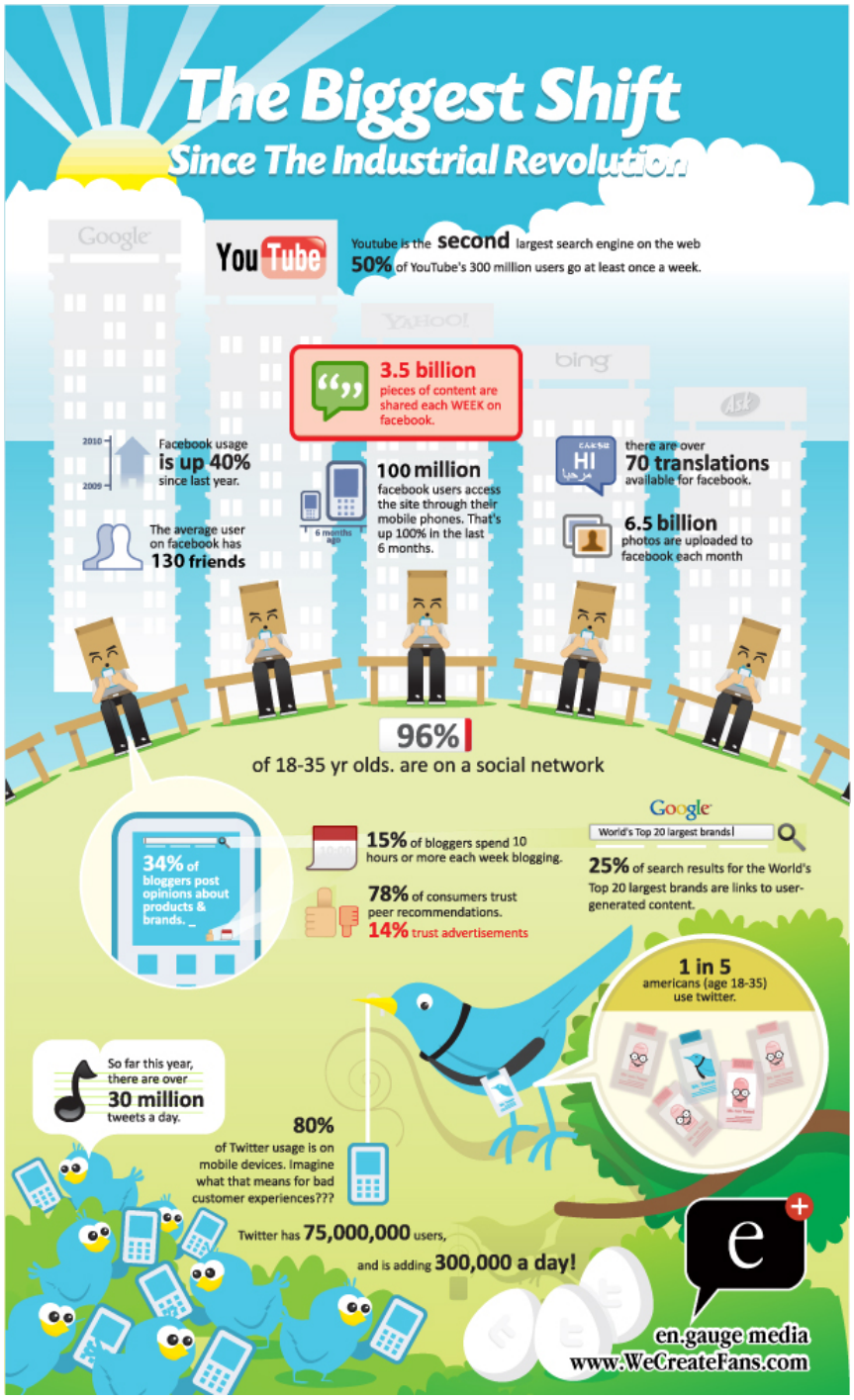


Figure 1 Social Media Revolution Source:

http://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Social_media_revolution.jpg

The term “media” is the tools we use and can include any technologies used for communication and interaction in conjunction with the web. Internet enabled mobile phones, netbooks and laptops can be used as well as traditional computers.

Social networking is the term used to describe two or more people interacting for a specific purpose. Commonly this is the use of online websites and applications to make connections with other people.

There are many reasons why people to want to connect, such as for a common interest such as hobbies, sporting activities and simply to extend personal relationships. Businesses may use online tools for trading - buying and selling - or for getting their services out to the public. Many social communities are formed for the sharing of knowledge, their beliefs and new items.

1.2 Types of tools and applications

There are many different tools and applications that are used for social networking. Each has a particular focus but all are predominantly information sharing tools. Many tools started out as single applications but are increasingly being merged into larger, all-inclusive applications.

Social media tools can be used by individuals for personal communication or for business use in marketing or public relations. Sites will give the contributor options for making their information public for anyone to view or private for individual access only. There are variations within this to allow restricted access specific individuals and groups of people.

Some of the main types of tools and application in common use include the following – click on an image for more information on the example site:

- Blogs (web logs) are part of a website set aside specifically for regular author comments and entries. This is often daily or weekly. They can also include images or video and links to other sites. Visitors are encouraged to interact and leave their own comments, feedback and links. Blogs are a way for authors to reflect on life or daily business and can become like an online diary or soapbox. Examples include:





Figure 1.2 Examples of Blog Sites

> Microblogs are typically smaller and more regular then traditional blogs. They are limited to short sentences to a maximum of 140 characters. You can also add images, video links and URL's. As well as being displayed in a web interface, postings can be forwarded to SMS or email. Examples include:



Figure 1.3 Examples of Microblog sites

> Music sharing sites specifically allow musicians to share their own works with the public. Musicians who have not been signed with a record company have an outlet to publish and sell their own original works to millions of people daily. Some of these sites feature creative remixes and mash-ups an example being:



Figure 1.4 Example of a music sharing sites

> Photo/image sharing sites allows users to post photography, video and personal artworks. It allows people to exhibit their own work and comment on the works of others. Works are categorised and tagged to enable efficient searching and linking. Examples include:



Figure 1.5 Examples of image sharing sites

> Social bookmarking sites allow users to store references to other sites by creating and organizing bookmarks, similar to storing favourite sites in your web browser software but accessible from any web enabled computer. Descriptions can be added to these bookmarks, including comments and voting. This is called social tagging where links are made between shared content. These sites can include highlighting tools and sticky notes. Sites can be made public or private. Examples include:



Figure 1.6 Examples of Social bookmarking sites

> Social networks are web sites that focus on building relationships between people with shared interests and/or activities. There are many tools offered by these sites to locate and link to families and friends, share photos, promote events and keep in touch with regular updates and postings. Examples include:



Figure 1.7 Examples of Social network sites

> Social news sites allow users to submit news items and stories on a particular subject from elsewhere on the web. Stories are ranked based on the number of submissions and then listed on the news site. Site users can then post comments and feedback on the stories, popularity then moves the news item higher on the list. Examples include:



Figure 1.8 Examples of Social news sites

> Video sharing sites specifically allow for the uploading, viewing and sharing of video content. User-generated content can include movie clips, TV clips, music videos, video blogging and short amateur videos. Content is publically available to viewers and can also be embedded into web pages outside of the hosting site. Examples include:



Figure 1.9 Examples of Video sharing sites

> Virtual worlds, or virtual hangouts, are online 3D communities where people can "virtually" walk around and interact with each other. Users create an online person called an avatar which is a 3D character that represents their own personality. Avatars can meet, socialise, buy and sell with virtual services and property. Many businesses and training organisations create virtual spaces to connect with potential customers. Examples include:



Figure 1.10 Examples of Virtual worlds

> Wikis are websites that can be created and modified by anyone using simple text editing tools through the web browser software. These are great to allow multiple people to collaborate and work on the same project from anywhere at any time. Different access rights can be granted to users to create, edit and delete information. The site can be made public or private. Examples:



Figure 1.11 Examples of Wikis

The above list explains distinct tools that are currently popular for personal and business use. More commonly these tools will be found merged or interlinked between applications so that updating one tool will display current information in another tool. The most difficult aspect is the requirement for multiple logins to distinct applications with no cross links. More applications now are starting to collaborate and link up allowing one logon to access multiple sites. This increases the networks created between people and organisations



LEARNING ACTIVITIES **ACTIVITY 1**

Research social media

1 Research the internet for one popular application of each of the types below (Try this list of social media and networking sites maintained by Traffikd).

2 List a few of the main features of each tool.

Table 1

Social media tool type	Popular software	Features
Blog	Blogger.com	Publish your thoughts template designer photo sharing updates from mobile phone
Microblog		
Music sharing		
Photo sharing		
Social bookmarking		
Social network		
Social news		
Video sharing		
Virtual world		
Wiki		

1.3 Issues with using social media

When you are posting personal information onto a public space there are many issues to be considered and huge potential for misuse:

Copyright – digital media (images, videos, podcasts, etc.) posted on public sites generally belong to the creator but are accessible for anyone to view, copy, modify and repost, sometimes for malicious purposes. Do you know how to protect your copyright? How do you know what media is copyright free or available under licence?

Ensure you have permission to use or post pictures of other people on your site. Be aware that even if you delete your space, the content still exists on a server somewhere.

Do you know the policies of the sites you are posting your content to – do you retain ownership of the copyright? Have you read the Terms and Conditions?

	**READINGS**	**RECOMMENDED 1**
Research Copyright - NSW Government Digital Citizenship site **- copyright**		

Privacy – controlling who sees your personal information is not always easy – there are often options available for limiting access but not all users correctly apply the privacy settings. The biggest concern is with predators faking identification and age and misleading young people into risky situations. Be wary of data theft, viruses. Organisations can build profiles of online habits and behaviours. Posted content has a way of spreading to a wide audience and does not disappear.

Do you really want everyone to know where you are, who you are with, what you are doing and your every thought? Think before you post.

	**READINGS**	**RECOMMENDED 2**
Research Privacy - Read more NSW Government Digital Citizenship site - privacy		

Security - most sites enable access through a username and password to prevent unauthorised people modifying your account details. It is important to keep this information secure so no-one can gain access and cause damage to your personal information. Use strong passwords and don't share them. Ensure you sign out of an account before leaving a computer unattended.

How secure is your information on the social media site? Is it vulnerable to theft?

	**READINGS**	**RECOMMENDED 3**
Research Security - Read more NSW Government Digital Citizenship site – security		

Trust – Most applications allow you to control who can see sections of your profile by granting different levels of trust – public, friends, family, colleagues, etc.

Do you know the consequences of the new features that are constantly being added to social media sites? How can you be sure the policies of the site haven't changed?

Beware over-posting too much information – your personal details, where you are, what you are doing – this information can be collected and used maliciously.

	**READINGS**	**RECOMMENDED 4**
Read more NSW Government Digital Citizenship site – Limits		



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Topic 2 - Compare different types of social media tools and applications

2.1 Review social media types

The use of social media is fast becoming a powerful tool for businesses to interact with their customers and network with potential customers. Clients provide feedback through comments, ratings and recommendations. Many organisations already have a public website but find the process of publishing updates is too slow and are utilizing one or more of the following types of tools for promotions:

Blogs and microblogs give organisations the ability to provide their customers with regular, up to the minute, information about their services and products, customer support and advertising. The power of positive feedback also being communicated by followers to their friends can be a very persuasive influence.

	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 2

Microblogging

1 Watch this microblogging online video

2 Or read the **Microblogging.pdf** file found here.

Photo, music and video sharing sites can be used to publish your own media to the web, including informative videos and podcasts. This tool allows people and businesses to increase their visibility with the general public and promote their brand with online content.

	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 3

Podcasting

1 Watch this podcasting online video

2 Or read the **Podcasting.pdf** file provided here.

Social bookmarking sites allow businesses to provide links to websites that may be of interest to customers or add to their experience. Tools are provided so web resources can be shared, organised and searched by users.

Social networks – the use of profiles, groups and user participation can promote the organisation and increase brand awareness. People are encouraged to like your brand, share links with friends and interact with comments and discussion. Photos and videos can be added to the profile to display your services to potential customers. When people "like" your brand and display this on their personal status page there is a powerful tendency for all their "friends" to visit your page – you have an instant link with friends of friends.

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 4

Social Media

1 Watch this social media online video

2 Or read the **Social Media.pdf** file provided here.

Wikis are an easy way for organisations to set up a collaborative workspace when contributors are spread out geographically and not located in the same office. Access can be granted to the general public to modify content such as Wikipedia (www.wikipedia.org) or only to specific people associated with the business. Pages can be added or the content edited and various media such as documents, videos, images and links can be uploaded to the site.

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 5

Wikis

1 Watch this collaborative writing online video

2 Or read the **Collaborative writing.pdf** file provided here.

RSS feeds are not specifically "social media" but are very useful to help aggregate (collect and sort) all frequently updated content from different sites across the web. Instead of you having to go to every site you are interested in to see any updated information, you can subscribe to a feed and have the new content delivered conveniently to you, all in one place. You need an RSS reader to regularly check your subscriptions, download updates, sort and manage the feeds. These will be waiting in your web browser for reading at a time convenient to you.

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 6

RSS feeds

1 Watch this RSS Feeds online video

2 Or read the RSS feed.pdf file provided here.

The choice of any of the above types of applications will depend on the requirements of the business and their specific communication needs. Careful consideration of the risks and the benefits of using these tools for external/public promotions should be undertaken first.

Organisations may also decide to utilize the above tools for internal communications. This involved configuring settings to private and only allowing employees access to the application. This may be particularly useful to allow staff to communicate and share resources and information. Staff can easily post news, ask questions and share achievements.

2.2 Popular tools and applications

The most popular social networking tool at the time of writing is Facebook. This site is evolving continuously and endeavouring to include all of the above tools to enable a single site for networking of people and organisations. Some of the activities and terminology for Facebook include:

- create a personal *profile*
- add a *friend*
- update your *status*
- *like* other people places or *pages*
- send *messages*
- create *events*
- ask *questions*
- upload *photos* and *video*
- play *games* and make *notes*
- search and connect to people

Facebook for mobile devices also allows you to check-in at a specific location and see who else is near you.

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 7

Facebook

Watch the following video – How to register and join Facebook – on eHow.com

Twitter is currently the most well-known/common blogging tool in used by people and organisations. The messages sent and received are called tweets.

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 8

Twitter

Watch the following video – Twitter in plain English – on YouTube

Wikis are web sites used to allow many people to access, edit and collaborate on different media. Terminology for wikis includes:

- create pages
- invite people
- post to a discussion group
- insert links
- upload files.

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 9

Wikis

Watch the following YouTube videos:

1 Wikispaces tutorial

2 How to use Wikispaces

Both the above tools were used extensively by emergency services during the 2011 Queensland Flood crisis.

	READINGS	RECOMMENDED 5

Social media in action

Read the following article – Social media vs the floods

	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 10

Review one social media type

Research, select and conduct a review on an appropriate social media tool:

1 Select one social media type

2 Review the most popular tools and applications within this type

3 Itemise the benefits from the use of this application

4 Select the most suitable and give your reasons



Topic 3 - Set up and use popular social media tools and applications

When the decision has been made to setup a web presence for an individual or an organisation there are a number of steps to take:

1 Determine the business needs

2 Identify the tool or application to use

3 Initiate the tool – create a logon account and set up the preferences

4 Establish the interface – this will involve adding text and media content such as images, videos, documents, etc.

5 Commence the social networking interaction – invite people to join, link to other groups, etc.

6 Test and evaluate the tool

7 Present findings

The above steps will differ depending on the type of tool or application selected.

In the following activities you will use of a variety of social media tools, including your own web site created using a wiki tool. The theme for the site will be based on these exercises and your experiences/reflection.

For each application you may need to create a new account or, if you are already a member, you may use an existing logon. **Hint**: You may want to create a free webmail account to keep these activities separate to your personal/student email address.

You are required to keep a journal of your online activities and record steps taken, URL's, usernames (keep passwords private) and any other information you will need to remember to revisit the sites and use the tools. Capture screen shots at relevant points and paste these into the document. **Note**: Alt+PrntScrn to capture screen shot, then place cursor at the point in the document you want the image to go and click Paste.

	**LEARNING ACTIVITIES**	**ACTIVITY 11**

RSS 

1 While performing these exercises look for the RSS logo and subscribe to any interesting "social media" feeds

2 View feeds in your web browser (Internet Explorer menu, View, Explorer bars, Feeds)

3 Comment on your experience.

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 12

Setup a Wiki

1 Select a Wiki site of your choice

2 Create a Wiki member account

3 Configure the settings and create a basic profile page

4 Create a new Wiki

- suggested name: mysocialmediatools followed by your full initials ie: mysocialmediatools-ABC
- Permissions: Protected (free)
- Type: personal

5 Browse through the "getting started" page

6 Go to Manage Wiki – Notifications

- Email – notify all changes
- RSS Feed - track all changes

7 Edit the home page with a basic introduction

8 Manage wiki - set the look and feel for the site

9 Create a new page and upload an image

10 Create a new page and embed a map

11 Continue to trial the different tools – add links, documents, etc.

12 Comment on your experience

	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 13

Setup a social networking site

1 Logon and configure your profile

2 Upload an image

3 Update your status

4 Search for an interesting "social media" page and link to it

5 Comment on your experience

	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 14

Setup a Blog or Microblog

1 Create an account

2 Search for "social media" topic of interest and follow it

3 Make a comment

4 Create a new conversation and respond to any feedback

5 Comment on your experience

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 15

Video sharing

1 Search for "social media" videos

2 Post a response

3 Embed one video in your wiki

4 Upload a video you have created or been supplied

5 Use keywords to tag the video and respond to any feedback

6 Comment on your experience

LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 16

Photo sharing

1 Search for images of "social media"

2 Download a copyright free image and add to your wiki

3 Comment on your experience

	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	ACTIVITY 17

Finalise your Wiki site

1 Create a new page named: Review

2 For each application trialled add a review based on your comments from each of the above Activities

3 Upload a copy of this completed task document

4 Invite people to view your site (your teacher minimum)

5 Approve your teacher as a member

6 The wiki can be deleted when unit is completed